OPEN LETTER · EYE ON SHOALHAVEN COUNCIL

Letter urges Shoalhaven Council to debate handling of Code of Conduct complaints

Sent 16 August 2026 · To Shoalhaven City Council, Cr Boyd, Cr Killian, Cr Krikstolaitis, Cr Norris, Cr Tribe, Cr Proudfoot, Cr Wilkins, Cr Dunn · Response requested by 6 September 2026

Please find attached an open letter to the (Acting) Mayor and the CEO. In short, the letter makes it clear that failing to help correct behaviour under the code of conduct arrangements does NOBODY any good.

If the behaviours are repeated, all it generates is more complaints, more work and more cost to ratepayers.

The way to reduce the cost is NOT to battle with complainants; it is to quickly look into the matter and resolve the behaviour.

In short, if the cost of the code of conduct is blowing out, the first place to look is how these matters are being handled;
if they are being handled like a criminal case, costs will blow out.
If it is used as a tool to improve behaviour, then it is a pretty simple issue.

I would suggest that, as a strategic issue, this is a matter for council to debate openly, and a notice of motion could be drafted around the suggestions I have included for reporting, which is in council's hands.

Steve Prothero
Eye on Shoalhaven Council
Community Journalism